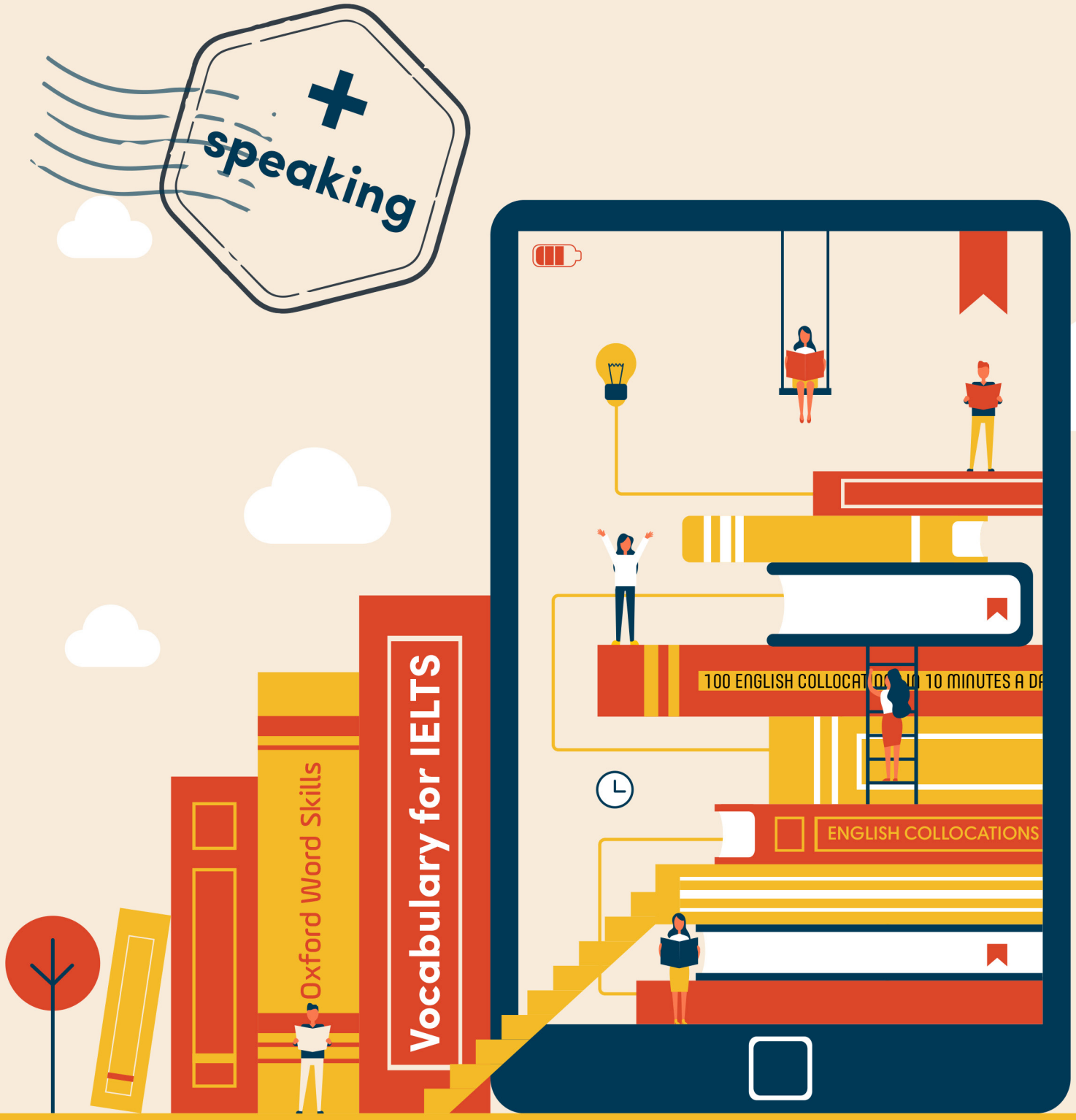
IELTS Up Words!

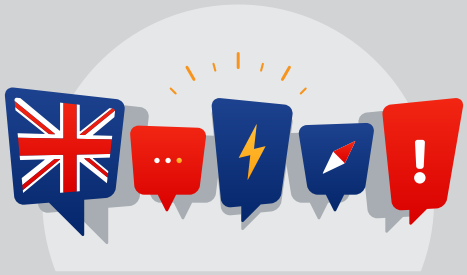
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IELTS Up Words!

Lesson 70: Natural Disasters

Hello there! Welcome to lesson seventy of IELTS Up Words! Oh my! Only eleven more lessons to go? What? I cannot express how proud I am that you have managed to get this far! Just WOW! On behalf of the Lingemy team, let me give you a round of applause!

We have already talked about climate change, the weather, and other environmental problems such as pollution.

Now, let's learn some words on the topic of natural phenomena and natural disasters.

But what exactly are natural phenomena? Types of natural phenomena include fog, thunder, tornadoes, decomposition, germination, wave propagation, erosion, tidal flow, and natural disasters such as volcanic eruptions, flooding, and earthquakes.

Now let me draw your attention to an interesting definition of natural disasters by the United Nations. A natural disaster is defined by the UN as "the consequences of events triggered by natural hazards that overwhelm local response capacity and seriously affect the social and economic development of a region." In other words, if an earthquake takes place on an uninhabited island and no one is affected, it is not a natural disaster. For a natural phenomenon to be considered a disaster, people must be affected by it.

So, which of these natural phenomena are common where you live? Can you describe them? Well, as for where I live, earthquakes are a pretty common occurrence. There are several active faults near Tehran that can cause large-magnitude earthquakes and aftershocks. Unfortunately, for a city like Tehran, which is prone to earthquakes, not enough measures have been taken by the municipal government to make Tehran earthquake-proof. I really hope that the authorities address this issue before a tremor or even worse a quake takes the city by surprise.

Now, let's answer another part-three question on natural disasters. I am going to use the listing technique to answer this question. Ready?

What measures can governments take to protect their citizens from natural disasters?

Well, there are, of course, plenty of steps that governments can take to guarantee the safety of their citizens. First, they can ensure that their communities are better prepared for natural disasters. They can do so by increasing funding to local authorities to help with building shelters and purchasing necessary equipment. Second, they can conduct disaster simulation drills to make sure everyone—including the first responders—knows what to do when a disaster strikes. And finally, they can install an early warning system for timely prediction of disastrous events, such as tsunamis, earthquakes, and volcanic eruptions. This system is probably able to mitigate economic losses and the number of casualties.

Speaking Tip

The Memory Palace

- A Memory Palace is an imaginary location in your mind where you can store mnemonic images.
- This is another technique to help you retain words faster and easier.

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
natural phenomena	things that exist and can be seen, felt, or tasted, especially something unusual or interesting	پدیده‌های طبیعی	singular: phenomenon natural/historical/social/etc. phenomenon
decomposition	the process of breaking down organic material, such as dead plants, into smaller and simpler parts, especially by living things (such as bacteria)	تجزیه	to decompose
germination	the process of a seed starting to grow, or the act of causing a seed to start growing	رویش	to germinate
wave propagation	the ways in which waves travel	انتشار موج	propagate
erosion	the fact of soil, stone, etc. being gradually damaged and removed by the waves, rain, or wind	فرسایش	soil/coastal erosion
tidal flow	the water current caused by the tides (the rise and fall of sea levels)	جریان آب ناشی از جزرومد	tidal current; tidal wave
volcanic eruptions	natural events where hot materials (called lava) from the Earth's interior are thrown out of a volcano	فوران‌های آتشفشانی	volcanic activity erupt; dormant
triggered by natural hazards	something caused by natural events that have negative effects on humans or the environment	چیزی که رخدادش ناشی از خطرات طبیعی است	
overwhelm local response capacity	when the severity (seriousness) of a natural event is too much for the local authorities to manage	وقتی ظرفیت پاسخگویی محلی جوابگو نباشد	

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
an uninhabited island	an island where no one lives	جزیرهٔ خالی‌ازسکنه	a deserted island
a pretty common occurrence	an event or incident that happens repeatedly	یک اتفاق بسیار رایج	a frequent/ common/rare occurrence
active faults	faults (cracks in the earth's surface) that are likely to become the source of other earthquakes sometime in the future	گسل‌های فعال	fault lines
large-magnitude earthquakes	very powerful earthquakes	زلزله‌های قدرتمند؛ زلزله‌هایی با شدت زیاد	opposite: small-magnitude
aftershocks	smaller earthquakes following the main shock of a large earthquake	پس‌لرزه‌ها	a series of aftershocks
this city is prone to earthquakes	this city is likely to experience earthquakes	این شهر زلزله‌خیز است	
earthquake-proof	designed in a way that will not be badly damaged by earthquakes; designed to resist the effects of earthquakes	مقاوم در برابر زلزله	earthquake-resistant an earthquake-proof building
tremor	a small earthquake in which the ground shakes slightly	زلزلهٔ خفیف	a slight earthquake an earth tremor
takes the city by surprise	shocks the city	ساکنان شهر را غافلگیر می‌کند	take someone/ something by surprise

topic-related words and structures	meaning	translation	other structures
to conduct disaster simulationdrills	to perform a fictional disaster event to prepare people for a real emergency	انجام تمرین شبیه‌سازی فاجعه	safety drill; fire drill
first responders	people with specialized training who are among the first to arrive and provide assistance at the scene of an emergency, such as an accident or a natural disaster	افرادی که عضو نیروی پلیس، آتش‌نشانی، یا کادر بیمارستان هستند و در شرایط اضطراری در صف اول کمک‌رسانی قرار دارند	second responders (= workers who support "first responders")
an early warning system	a system or equipment designed to predict and reduce the harm of natural and human-initiated disasters and other undesirable events	سیستم هشدار اولیه؛ سیستم پیش‌آگاهی	
timely prediction	predicting an event on time before its occurrence	پیش‌بینی به‌موقع	a well-timed/ opportune warning
to mitigate economic losses	to reduce the amount of money lost by businesses and organizations	کاستن زیان‌های اقتصادی	to lessen/alleviate
casualties	people injured or killed in a serious accident or war	مصدومان؛ تلفات	singular: casualty

other words/ structures	meaning	translation	other structures
on behalf of someone	done for another person's benefit or support, or because you are representing the interests of that person	به نفع کسی؛ به نمایندگی از کسی	on somebody's behalf; on my behalf
to draw your attention to something	to make you notice something	نظر شما را به چیزی جلب کردن	to draw attention to yourself
the municipal government	relating to the government of a city or town, rather than the government of a country	دولت و مقامات شهری	municipal authorities/councils/ departments municipal elections
the authorities	the group of people with the official legal power to make decisions or make people obey the laws in a particular area, such as the police or a local government agency	مسئولان؛ صاحبان قدرت	singular: an authority
to increase funding	to increase the amount of money given by an organization or a government for a particular purpose	افزودن منابع مالی	secure/obtain/get funding federal/ government/state funding a reduction/cut/ increase in funding



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